20 IDEAS

For Group Projects

5/20 : VARIATIONS OF THEME



1) Course Textbook Video

Students record a brief video on a topic of no more than 5 minutes. Best videos go in the (free!) course textbook. Videos are assessed by other students and TA and you.



2) Daily Teach

Students are in groups of four, one student teaches for five minutes at the start of each day. Students choose their topics, but must choose something that is on exam. Other students score using FF.



3) Name-out-the-hat Presentation

Every student must prepare, only one is chosen. Other students can give an "assist" as needed. All students score using FF.

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4) Debunking Video

Students prepare a short social-media-ready video on a topic from your class. No more than 2 minutes total. Must include references, including academic work. Students score each other.



5) Group Essay

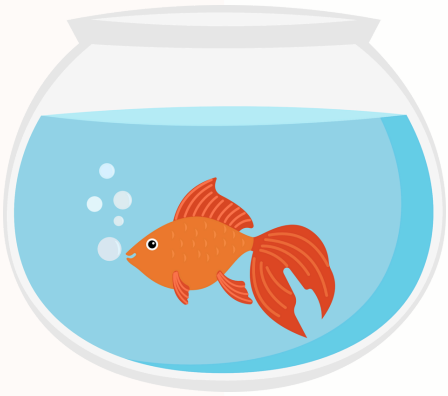
Same as a group presentation but easier to grade: 5 pages max.

Assign roles! It helps!

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10/20 : DISCUSSION



6) The Fishbowl

Give a few minutes to prep for the fishbowl. Then, ~6 students sit in the fishbowl, the rest stand outside. Teacher taps students in and out once they've contributed. Make sure to end with some closure and synthesis!



7) Jigsaw

Students are in groups of four, and number off. All the 1s read article A, all the 2s read article B and so on. After enough time to read and consider, students are brought back to mixed groups to synthesize all four articles to the group.



8) World Cafe

Four-to-six tables, each with a topic and "host" student. Class members choose tables to discuss deep ideas at, or use a bell to transition.



9) Socractic Circle

Choose a juicy, short text that raises delicious questions. Inner circle discusses the juicy questions while the outer circle assesses the quality of their thinking. Then swap.



10) Soapbox

Welcome to Hyde Park! Soapbox students stand on a box and deliver their position on a key theme from class. Other students ask questions, debate, argue, and yes, heckle!

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15/20 : ASSESSMENTS



11) Oral Exams

Three students picked randomly to answer questions on a text, reading, or core theme from the class. Teacher scored. Other students generate questions, score students, or take notes.



12) Expert Panel

Three students make up the panel, and other students ask them questions about a key theme from the class. The "experts" teach the class the content.



13) Group Exams

Students may take exam or quiz in groups, but must argue in front of you to explain the justification for their answers.



14) Teach me!

It's fun to play dumb! Pretend you don't "get it" about a certain topic, and this group has to help you get it! They have five minutes to convey a principle that is tricky in a clear way!



15) Teach Ten!

Before taking the exam, you have to teach ten classmates, TAs, professors, family members, or stuffed animals!

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20/20 : SIMULATIONS



16) Case Study Analysis

Build a juicy, intriguing case study. Assign a few students to be in the inside group, and assign roles. Have them discuss in front of the class, and then assess their thinking with the rest of the class.



17) Model UN

Mock trial. Model UN. Geology panel. Dress rehearsal. Draft IEP Meeting. Build a real-life simulation that is authentic for your field, and then have students participate! Grade them on their actual performance. Some of the highest-order thinking you'll see!



18) Role-play

These are ideal for performance-based skills: teaching, nursing, customer service, etc. Make sure to use a rubric!



19) Internship

There's always chances to include internships, even if it doesn't seem it at first! For example, extra credit if a student can design ____ for the class textbook! They have skills--let them use them!



20) Consultancy Project

Students only THINK they are students--in fact, they are super secret consultant ninjas! They were hired to give you feedback on your course! What can I do better? 15 minute presentation, recorded.

EVERYTHING WRONG

with 20-Minute Group Presentations

FEEDBACK

"It'll take a month of class at the end"
"I'll give you three days to prep"
"I was the only one who did any work"
"The definition of one-shot"
"The worst part of the class"
"Only presenters are engaged"
"You aren't assessing. Not really."

HOW TO MAKE IT BETTER

Translating: Bad to Good

BAD	GOOD
Last month of class? For 20 minutes apiece?	Change to 5 minutes! Submit recorded videos instead of in-class!
One student doing all the work?	Have students present individually! Or groupwork with roles! Or peer-grading!
One-shot assessment?	Maximize feedback and opportunities!